1. When did Aspire start feeling like a real company?

2. How did you convince people to work for you when the company was brand new?

3. What's something you stopped doing yourself that made the business better?

4. What do you spend money on now that you couldn't justify when you started?

5. What's harder: finding good employees or keeping them?

6. How do you know when someone is ready for more responsibility?

7. What's one thing you learned in accounting that gives you an advantage in real estate?

8. What's the difference between being a great broker and running a great brokerage?

9. What do successful real estate owners disagree with you about?

10. What's something a client taught you that changed how you do business?

11. What makes you recommend that a client do nothing?

12. When does buying your own office make sense for a business owner?

13. What type of business is the hardest to find space for?

14. What do business owners underestimate about opening a second location?

15. What makes two buildings across the street from each other worth completely different amounts?

16. What's something you can learn about a neighborhood just by looking at its businesses?

17. How can you tell whether a struggling property has potential or is just a bad property?

18. What's a real estate opinion you have that other brokers disagree with?

19. Has AI changed what you look for when hiring?

20. If Aspire doubled in size tomorrow, what would break first?

21. Overrated or underrated: choosing an office

- Having your company's name on the building
- Everyone getting a private office
- Being close to the founder's house
- Being close to where employees live
- Having room to double your team
- Being in the same area as your competitors

22. Green flag or red flag: choosing a company to work for

- The founder still interviews every candidate
- Most managers were promoted from within
- The company is hiring a lot of people at once
- The interviewer openly discusses what's going wrong
- Your compensation depends heavily on team performance
- The company expects you to work in the office every day

23. This or that: building a brokerage career

- Smaller commission split with great support or a bigger split on your own?
- One major client or ten smaller clients?
- Specialize in one neighborhood or one property type?
- Join an established team or help build a new one?
- Represent owners or represent tenants?
- A difficult deal with a great client or an easy deal with a difficult client?

24. Rank how difficult these businesses are to find space for

1 = straightforward; 10 = very difficult.

- Restaurant
- Daycare
- Auto repair shop
- Fitness studio
- Medical practice
- Law firm

25. Overrated or underrated: starting a business

- Having a cofounder
- A detailed five-year business plan
- A prestigious business address
- Hiring someone with big-company experience
- Paying for experienced outside advice
- Having a large social media following before you launch

26. Green flag or red flag: a business choosing its first space

- Wants to be near its biggest competitor
- Will pay more to stay close to its existing customers
- Wants extra space for growth that hasn't happened yet
- Brings its contractor to the tour
- Wants a long lease before the business has opened
- Prefers an older space so it can spend more on equipment

27. This or that: hiring for your company

• Industry experience or a track record of learning quickly?

• A top performer from a big company or someone who helped build a small one?

• Hire ahead of growth or wait until the team is stretched?

• Promote someone internally or bring in an experienced manager?

• One expensive senior hire or two junior hires?

• Someone who challenges your approach or someone who executes it consistently?

28. Good, better, best: where would you spend the money?

Brandon orders each set based on the situation.

• A struggling shopping center: lower rents / improve the property / change the tenant mix

• A growing brokerage: another broker / administrative support / better marketing

• A business opening its first location: better address / better interior / more cash left over

• An owner with an upcoming vacancy: renovate immediately / wait for a tenant's requirements / offer a buildout allowance

29. What matters more when choosing a commercial space?

• Street visibility or easy access?

• More parking or more interior space?

• Close to customers or close to employees?

• Lower rent or less money needed upfront?

• Move-in ready or exactly the layout you want?

• A longer lease at a better rate or a shorter commitment?

30. Green flag or red flag: a young broker building a career

• Turns down a deal outside their specialty

• Admits they don't know the answer in front of a client

• Asks to sit in on another broker's negotiations

• Wants to start their own firm eventually

• Spends money on an assistant early

• Questions advice from a more experienced broker